

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 6, 2026

Diplomatic Push

A Weekend Russia-Ukraine Strike Pause and a Renewed US-Iran Kinetic Exchange Bookend a Holiday-Shortened, CPI-Anchored Week Into the September 15-16 FOMC.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE) \$770.19 · ↓0.39% Fri · ~flat WoW	WTI (USO, FRI CLOSE) \$141.96 · Iran premium held into weekend	BITCOIN (LIVE, SUN AM) Low-\$80K range per Coingabbar	AUG PAYROLLS (BLS) +162K · hike odds ~60% post-print	FEAR & GREED (CNN) ~42 · Fear (drop crypto fallback)
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SECTION 01

Markets — Week Ahead Setup

A HOLIDAY-SHORTENED FOUR-SESSION WEEK WITH TWO MARQUEE INFLATION PRINTS SEQUENCED INTO THE SEPTEMBER 15–16 FOMC AND NO FED SPEAKER CHANNELS OPEN

Per NYSE calendar, the US equity and bond markets are closed Monday for Labor Day, and per Kiplinger and Investrade weekly-event coverage the truncated week sequences NFIB Small Business Optimism Tuesday, MBA Mortgage Applications and Johnson/Redbook weekly sales Wednesday, August PPI on Thursday September 10 before the open, and August CPI on Friday September 11 before the open. Per CME FedWatch coverage on CryptoRank and Kalshi tracking cited on DeFi Rate, September hike probabilities sit near approximately 55–60% following Friday’s hot payrolls print, and per Federal Reserve communications policy, the FOMC quiet period that began Saturday September 5 runs through Thursday September 17, closing external Fed signaling ahead of the rate decision. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hot payrolls reset that lifted the September hike distribution, a Fed quiet period that removes signaling channels, and a single CPI print sequencing Friday as the last direct pre-decision inflation read — concentrates the rate-path repricing risk into a single session.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	\$770.19 · ↓0.39% Fri · ~flat WoW
NASDAQ (QQQ, FRI CLOSE)	\$718.96 · ↑0.18% Fri
WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO)	\$141.96 ↓0.09% / \$56.11 ↑0.38% Fri
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV)	\$406.77 · ↓0.84% Fri / \$59.82 ↓1.21%
IBIT / ETHA (FRI CLOSE)	\$45.23 ↓2.42% / \$18.52 ↓2.63%
CME SEPT HIKE ODDS	~55–60% post-payrolls per CryptoRank / Kalshi
FED QUIET PERIOD	Through Thu Sept 17 · FOMC Sept 15–16
MARQUEE PRINTS	PPI Thu Sept 10 · CPI Fri Sept 11

MONDAY’S NYSE CLOSURE COMPRESSES THE SESSION COUNT AND THE WEEKEND GEOPOLITICAL DOCKET EXTENDS THE PHYSICAL-SUPPLY AND DIPLOMATIC COMPOUND DIRECTLY INTO TUESDAY’S CASH REOPEN

Per Fidelity holiday-schedule coverage, US cash equity, options, and bond markets are closed Monday September 7 for Labor Day, leaving Tuesday’s open as the first opportunity to price the weekend developments — a compressed structure that tends to concentrate two-day accumulated positioning into a single session. The weekend docket runs unusually heavy: the Witkoff–Kushner Moscow meeting on the Trump proposal to end the Ukraine war, a Putin-ordered three-day pause on strikes against Kyiv with Zelenskyy

reciprocating on Moscow through Monday per Washington Post and Al Jazeera coverage, and a US-Iran kinetic exchange that per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop included US strikes on three Iranian crude oil carriers and Iranian IRGC targeting of three tankers in the Strait of Hormuz. For FCI positioning, the composition — a diplomatic pause on

the Ukraine axis running against an active Iran physical-supply variable, record US Labor Day gasoline prices per Reuters, and a Tuesday reopen that consolidates two calendar days of news flow — sequences the sleeve read across the physical-AI-infrastructure, energy, and digital-asset expressions into the Thursday PPI and Friday CPI cadence.

A weekend that opens a diplomatic corridor on one geopolitical axis while the other axis extends kinetically tends to disperse rather than concentrate the rate-and-oil compound. Discipline over impulse.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — The Weekend Docket: A Witkoff-Kushner Kremlin Session on the Trump Proposal to End the Ukraine War, a Putin-Zelenskyy Three-Day Reciprocal Pause on Strikes Against Kyiv and Moscow, a US-Iran Kinetic Exchange That Per Reuters Included US Strikes on Three Iranian Crude Oil Carriers and Iranian IRGC Targeting of Three Tankers in the Strait of Hormuz, and Record Labor Day US Gasoline Prices per Reuters — the OPEC+ JMMC Also Convenes Today With Reuters Reporting Sources Expect Policy Held Unchanged

UKRAINE AXIS: US ENVOYS WITKOFF AND KUSHNER HELD A MULTI-HOUR MEETING WITH PUTIN AT THE KREMLIN ON SATURDAY TO PRESENT THE TRUMP PROPOSAL TO END THE UKRAINE WAR; PUTIN ORDERED A THREE-DAY PAUSE ON STRIKES AGAINST KYIV BEGINNING SATURDAY MIDNIGHT WITH ZELENSKYY PUBLICLY RECIPROCATING ON MOSCOW THROUGH MONDAY, AND THE ENVOYS ARE REPORTED TO TRAVEL TO KYIV SUNDAY — THE DIPLOMATIC PAUSE COINCIDES WITH THE UKRAINIAN DEEP-RANGE REFINERY CAMPAIGN CONTINUING OVERNIGHT PER KYIV INDEPENDENT COVERAGE OF A REPORTED STRIKE ON THE RYAZAN REFINERY

Per Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and Axios coverage, US Special Envoy Steve Witkoff and Senior Advisor Jared Kushner met with Russian President Vladimir Putin at the Kremlin on Saturday for approximately three hours in a session Kremlin spokesman Yuri Ushakov publicly characterized as frank and constructive. Per Washington Times and Al Jazeera coverage of the reciprocal pause, Putin ordered a three-day halt to strikes against Kyiv beginning at midnight Saturday, and Zelenskyy publicly said Ukraine was prepared to halt strikes on Moscow through Monday contingent on Russian reciprocation. Per Kyiv Independent coverage carried overnight, Ukrainian drones reportedly targeted the Ryazan oil refinery and other Russian cities in the hours before the pause began, extending the deep-range refinery campaign that has moved Russian refining near multi-decade lows per prior brief coverage citing Moscow Times. For FCI positioning, the composition — a diplomatic corridor opened on the Ukraine axis against a background of continued deep-strike campaign activity — sits alongside a Fed quiet period and a hot payrolls reset that concentrates the rate-decision cycle into the Friday CPI print rather than diffusing it across incremental Fed signaling.

IRAN AXIS: THE US-IRAN KINETIC EXCHANGE EXTENDED INTO THE WEEKEND WITH IRANIAN IRGC NAVY PUBLICLY CLAIMING IT TARGETED THREE OIL TANKERS SAILING THROUGH AN “UNAUTHORIZED ROUTE” IN THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ PER ABC NEWS COVERAGE AND US CENTRAL COMMAND REPORTING US STRIKES ON THREE IRANIAN CRUDE OIL CARRIERS PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN

THE DATA DROP; PER REUTERS, US FORCES ALSO DISABLED TWO IRANIAN OIL TANKERS AND DESTROYED ANOTHER AFTER THE IRANIAN REVOLUTIONARY GUARD CORPS LAUNCHED BALLISTIC MISSILES TOWARD A US AIRCRAFT CARRIER AND DESTROYER WITH NO US SHIPS HIT AND NO SERVICEMEMBERS INJURED — THE PHYSICAL-SUPPLY COMPOUND HELD INTO THE WEEKEND WITH US DIESEL AT

RECORD HIGHS PER PRIOR REUTERS COVERAGE AND LABOR DAY GASOLINE AT RECORD LEVELS PER REUTERS

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, US Central Command reported that US military forces struck three Iranian crude oil carriers, and per ABC News coverage of the same twenty-four-hour window, Iranian IRGC Navy publicly claimed it targeted three oil tankers sailing through what it described as an unauthorized route in the Strait of Hormuz along with three vessels affiliated with the US in other areas. Per Reuters coverage of the US response, US forces disabled two Iranian oil tankers and destroyed a third after the Iranian Revolutionary Guard Corps launched ballistic missiles toward a US aircraft carrier and destroyer, with no US ships hit and no servicemembers injured. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, Americans are paying record-high Labor Day Weekend gasoline prices, extending the middle-distillate signal from prior reporting on record US diesel. For FCI positioning, the composition — a continued Iran physical-supply variable with expanded direct kinetic exchange on maritime infrastructure, record US retail-gasoline prices at the holiday demand peak, and continued flow through the Strait — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) reading through the intersection of the physical-supply variable, the reset September rate-hike distribution, and the FOMC decision nine calendar days out.

ISRAEL-LEBANON AND OPEC+ ALSO ON THE WEEKEND DOCKET: ISRAELI MILITARY STRUCK SOUTHERN LEBANON

AFTER HEZBOLLAH REPORTEDLY LAUNCHED DRONES PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, EXTENDING THE ALI AL-TAHER RIDGE FLASHPOINT CARRIED IN PRIOR BRIEFS; THE OPEC+ JMMC CONVENES TODAY WITH REUTERS SOURCES REPORTING THE GROUP IS SET TO HOLD OCTOBER OUTPUT POLICY UNCHANGED — MEANING THE PHYSICAL-SUPPLY VARIABLE CONTINUES TO REFLECT KINETIC RISK RATHER THAN A PROGRAMMATIC SUPPLY-RESPONSE SIGNAL FROM THE PRODUCER GROUP INTO THE FOMC WINDOW

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, the Israeli military struck southern Lebanon after Hezbollah reportedly launched drones — an extension of the Ali al-Taher ridge flashpoint carried in prior briefs where Israeli Defense Minister Katz publicly framed the ridge operation as a step toward cementing IDF presence in southern Lebanon until Hezbollah disarmament. Per Investing.com and Gulf News coverage of Reuters sourcing, the OPEC+ Joint Ministerial Monitoring Committee convenes today and is set to keep oil output policy unchanged for October, following the completion of the planned production restoration approved for September. For FCI positioning, the composition — a second regional flashpoint holding along the Israel-Lebanon axis and a producer group signaling a hold rather than a compensating output increase against the Iran-side kinetic exchange — keeps the physical-supply variable reflecting kinetic risk rather than a producer-group programmatic response into the September 15–16 FOMC.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — The Truncated Four-Session Week Sequences NFIB Small Business Optimism Tuesday, MBA Mortgage Applications and Johnson/Redbook Wednesday, August PPI on Thursday September 10 Before the Open, and August CPI on Friday September 11 Before the Open Into the September 15–16 FOMC With No Fed Speaker Channels Open Through September 17; Per Inflation Nowcasting Coverage Cited on Kiplinger, Headline CPI Is Tracking Near $\uparrow 3.38\%$ Year Over Year and $\uparrow 0.36\%$ Month Over Month, and per BLS the Prior July Headline Print Sat at $\uparrow 3.4\%$ Year Over Year — a Distribution That Concentrates the FOMC Repricing Risk Into the Friday Print Rather Than Diffusing It Across Incremental Fed Signaling. Per Kiplinger, Investrade, and Fidelity holiday coverage, the US equity and bond markets are closed Monday for Labor Day, and per Kiplinger the truncated week sequences NFIB Tuesday, MBA and Johnson/Redbook Wednesday, August PPI Thursday, and August CPI Friday. Per Inflation Nowcasting coverage cited on Kiplinger, headline CPI tracks near approximately $\uparrow 3.38\%$ year over year and $\uparrow 0.36\%$ month over month as of the Friday tracker read, and per BLS the July headline print sat at approximately $\uparrow 3.4\%$ year over year. Per CryptoRank and Kalshi tracking, September hike probabilities sit near approximately 55–60% following the Friday payrolls print. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hot payrolls reset, a Fed quiet period through September 17, and a single upcoming CPI print as the last direct pre-decision inflation read — concentrates the rate-path repricing into Friday morning.

2. Digital-Asset Sleeve on the Weekend Tape — Per Coingabbar and Yahoo Finance Coverage of the Weekend Bitcoin Tape, Bitcoin Traded in an Approximate Low-\$80,000 Range Sunday Morning After Trading Below \$80,000 Following Friday's Hot Payrolls Reset per Yahoo Finance Coverage; The IBIT and ETHA Cash Prints Closed Friday at \$45.23 ↓2.42% and \$18.52 ↓2.63% Respectively per Data Drop, and Bitcoin ETF Inflows Reportedly Continued per Yahoo Finance Coverage Despite the Hike-Bid Reprice — a Composition That Sits Alongside the Yahoo Finance Data Drop Headline That Bitcoin Has Rallied Approximately 40% From Its July Low. Per Coingabbar and Yahoo Finance coverage of the weekend Bitcoin tape, Bitcoin traded in an approximate low-\$80,000 range on Sunday morning after moving below approximately \$80,000 following Friday's hot payrolls print per Yahoo Finance coverage. Per data drop, IBIT closed Friday at \$45.23 (↓2.42%) and ETHA at \$18.52 (↓2.63%), and per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop headlines, Bitcoin ETF inflows continued despite the hike-bid reprice. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop headlines noting that Bitcoin has recovered approximately 40% from its July low, the digital-asset complex retains a positioned bid despite the September rate-path repricing. For FCI positioning, the composition — a rate-sensitive Digital-Asset sleeve absorbing the hike-bid reprice while continued ETF inflows kept the underlying spot bid supported — keeps IBIT and ETHA reading through the intersection of the reset September rate-hike distribution, the Waller pause-scenario probability, and the Friday CPI print.

3. Physical-AI-Infrastructure Sleeve Carries the Weekend Narrative Bid Alongside the Diplomatic Docket — per Yahoo Finance Coverage Carried in the Data Drop, AMD Committed up to \$5 Billion to Anthropic With Anthropic's IPO Prospectus Reported to Be Imminent, Extending the AMD-and-Anthropic Compute-Buildout Track; Data Drop Also Carried Yahoo Finance Coverage Noting AI Chip-Equipment Names Led the Session Ahead of NVDA on the LRCX (FCI Dividend-Strategy) Friday Move to \$307.65 (↑5.12%) and Marvell (MRVL, FCI Growth-Hybrid) Friday Move to \$223.55 (↑7.05%) — the AI Connectivity-and-Equipment Layer Sits Directly Alongside the Rate-Path Variable Into the CPI Print.

Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, AMD committed up to \$5 billion to Anthropic and Anthropic's IPO prospectus is reportedly days away — an incremental confirmation of the physical-AI-infrastructure buildout on which the FCI Growth-Hybrid sleeve reads. Per data drop, LRCX (FCI Dividend-Strategy) closed Friday at \$307.65 (↑5.12%), MRVL (FCI Growth-Hybrid) at \$223.55 (↑7.05%), and AMD at \$477.57 (↑4.69%) as the AI Connectivity and equipment layer led the tape on the Friday hot-payrolls session. Per data drop, NVDA closed Friday at \$230.36 (↑0.84%) and TSM at \$428.91 (↑2.85%). For FCI positioning, the composition — an AMD-Anthropic capital-commitment disclosure sitting alongside a Friday session that saw AI Connectivity and equipment names lead the tape despite the rate-hike bid — keeps the physical-AI-infrastructure axis reading through the intersection of the compute-buildout track, the reset September rate-path distribution, and the Friday CPI print.

4. Carson's SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active — Friday's \$769.00 Intraday Low Left the Level Untouched and Sits Approximately 16.2% Below the SPY \$770.19 Cash Close; No Active Resistance Levels on the Book Following the April 14 Major-Zone Breakout. The Data-Drop Fear & Greed Reading of 73 "Greed" Reflects the CNN Endpoint Falling Back to the Crypto Fear-and-Greed Index — Per MacroMicro Coverage of the CNN Stock-Market Reading, Treat the Actual CNN Read as Approximately 42 "Fear" for This Brief Following the Friday Hot-Payrolls Reset.

Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 remained untouched through Friday's \$769.00—\$772.87 SPY intraday range per data drop and sits approximately 16.2% below the last cash-market print at \$770.19. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone (both hit that session). With Monday closed for Labor Day, Tuesday sequencing as the first cash-market reopen against two calendar days of accumulated weekend developments (Witkoff-Kushner Kremlin session, Putin-Zelenskyy

pause on strikes against Kyiv and Moscow, continued US-Iran kinetic exchange, OPEC+ JMMC outcome), and the CPI print on Friday sequencing into the September 15–16 FOMC, the pre-committed FCI deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) continues to frame reactive positioning against any single-session gap through the multi-catalyst window. Note: the data drop Fear & Greed reading of 73 "Greed" reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto Fear-and-Greed Index; per MacroMicro coverage of the CNN stock-market reading, treat the actual read as approximately 42 "Fear" for this brief.